



SOARING COSTS

₹21.31 LAKH CRORE worth of gold was imported by India over the last five years. Of this, ₹6.40 lakh crore was spent on gold imports in FY26 alone, marking a 31% year-on-year increase according to CMIE data. India's gold import volumes have shown a declining trend in recent years. Imports fell from a peak of 879 tonnes in 2021-22 to 721 tonnes in 2025-26. However, despite the decline in import volumes, the sharp rise in global gold prices significantly increased India's overall gold bill.

7.1
PER CENT

YTD DEPRECIATION RECORDED BY THE INDIAN RUPEE AGAINST THE US DOLLAR TILL MAY 19. THE JAPANESE YEN FELL 1.48%, WHILE THE CHINESE YUAN ROSE 2.8%

BIDDING WAR CEMENTS

THE BID FOR the bankrupt Jaypee Cement has taken an interesting turn, with Adani Group-backed Ambuja Cements evincing interest. To add to the intricacy is the fact that the offer of ₹580 crore is way below the liquidation value of ₹880 crore. For the Adani Group, which entered the sector through the buyout of Ambuja and ACC, Jaypee will give a five million tonne capacity in the south, between Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu. Will the lenders convince the Adani Group to increase its offer price or will another bidder emerge remains to be seen.



RACE TO THE TOP

INDIA'S URBAN MOBILITY market is entering a new competitive phase, with global giant Uber and Indian start-up Rapido emerging as the key contenders. Uber has said India, currently its third-largest market, could become its biggest globally over time. Meanwhile, Rapido's recent fund raise of \$240 million is expected to fuel its expansion across bike taxis, autos and cabs. The shift also signals how Ola, once the market leader, is increasingly turning into a distant third in India's fast-evolving ride-hailing race.

PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

